

MODULE 10

Scaling: From 1 Property to 5 to 15

The first 3 properties teach you the work. Properties 4-9 teach you the systems. Properties 10-15 teach you the business. This module covers the inflection points and what changes at each one.

Properties 1-3: Do the work yourself

You are doing every message, every pricing update, every cleaning coordination yourself. This is the only way to learn what good looks like. Build your SOPs in real time, document them in Notion or a shared doc.

Time per property: 18-25 hours/week. Don't take a fourth property until your time per property is consistently below 12 hours/week.

Properties 4-9: Systematize

Hire your first cleaner. Build a cleaning checklist and a turnover workflow. Hire your first part-time helper or VA for guest communications. Document everything they need to read.

Two products at this stage — you have a cohosting practice (the work) and a cohosting business (the systems + the team + the leverage). The business is what scales; the practice is what pays you today.

Time per property with one helper: 8-12 hours/week.

Properties 10-15: Hire and delegate

Hire a second cleaner or a small cleaning team. Hire your first full-time assistant (operations coordinator). Train them on every SOP you have written. Their job is to run the SOPs, not to make decisions — decisions stay with you.

At 15 properties you are probably ready to hire a managing cohost (someone with a track record who can own 5-7 properties end-to-end under your brand). Your role shifts: account management, owner relationships, business development, pricing strategy.

Time per property with a coordinator + a managing cohost: 3-5 hours/week.

The mistake that kills most cohosting practices

Scaling too fast. Taking properties 5 and 6 before you have actually systematized properties 3 and 4. The result: every new property is more work, not less, and service quality collapses. Renewal rates drop. Referrals dry up. You burn out within 12-18 months and shut it down.

The discipline is: only take a new property when your existing portfolio is running at the time target for that scale (18h at 1-3, 10h at 4-9, 4h at 10-15). If you are not hitting the target, you are not ready to scale. Fix the systems first.

What comes after 15 properties

Two paths. You become a cohosting agency (a real entity with a brand, multiple operators, a sales pipeline, and a target of 30-100 properties). Or you stay as a high-touch solo operator with 12-15 properties at premium pricing. Both are real businesses. Most cohosts who hit 15 chose one within 90 days — usually whichever path better matches the energy they get from the work.

The Cohosting Startup Kit ends here.

If you made it through all 10 modules, you have the operating reference for a real cohosting practice: the operating definition, positioning, contracts, pricing, listing audit, guest screening, dynamic pricing, monthly statements, owner outreach, and the scaling path.

What you do with it is up to you. The 6-week Mentorship cohort at \$1,000 covers the parts this kit does not — live case review, your specific market, your specific challenges. If this kit raised as many questions as it answered, that is the right next step.